a majority of whom were unsuspecting farmers, to join the Khalistan movement. The propagandists claimed that the Indian government was usurping the power of gurudwaras, a focal point of Jagjit Singh Chohan's advertisement, and intelligence officers believed that was the only issue which could find traction with Sikhs otherwise loyal and devoted to India.

Analysts in the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) felt that Jagjit Singh Chohan need not be taken too seriously as his advertisement was denounced by Sikh leaders in the UK, many of whom were his close friends and associates. The MEA said:

We have reliable information that his trip has been sponsored and financed by Pakistan for its own purposes. He has recently written to some people of that Akali Dal here and we find that he has not mentioned his independent Sikhis-tan idea at all to them. As you have indicated in your telegrams one need not, therefore, take him seriously. However, we must prevent his making a nuisance of himself either in London or in New York or Washington during PM's visit there. Kindly take all necessary steps to ensure that no demonstration takes place while PM is there. PM's presence will naturally be sought by mischievous people to get a certain amount of publicity for themselves and their activities. Our objective has to be to ensure that they are not successful in this.

There were hectic activities within the R&AW to find out in what circumstances Chohan had left India and whether his adventurous trips had been planned and sponsored by the ISI, then headed by Major General Mohammad Akbar Khan. Their enquiries revealed that Chohan had been issued a passport on 20 August 1969, endorsed by the USA. On 30 June 1971,